

to accept their applications. *They were men who remembered him in connection with the services he rendered while he was giving away 90% of his time.*

In giving of his time, Mr. Choate never hinted that he wanted anything in return. Yet such is the Law of Compensation that a return is inevitable. You may wish to look at it this way: every time you share your blessings with another, you become his creditor. Eventually, the debt is paid. Somehow, debts have to be paid.

They gave away a philosophy and it returned manyfold. One of the most valuable gifts you can give any man is the gift of *direction*. Show him how to gather his forces and focus them the way he wants to go, and literally you do more for him than if you handed him a million dollars. Andrew Carnegie gave away multiple millions for the purpose of founding free libraries, hoping thus to disseminate knowledge of all kinds and lift the entire knowledge-level of a nation. Above and beyond this he made available the Science of Personal Achievement in which I have played my own part.

One of the greatest rewards of my life has been to see my book *Think and Grow Rich* given away as a means of spreading the philosophy. Mr. Choate is one of those who have given away hundreds of copies. Often he gives the book to men who by no stretch of the imagination ever will become prospects for life insurance. He gives the book to others because it helped him find himself. Undoubtedly it has brought him business. Undoubtedly it has helped many a man to be able to afford the life insurance he needs.

Another student of mine moved to Oakland, California, with a total capital of less than two hundred dollars. He invested half his capital in *Think and Grow Rich*. He made a practice of lending the book to his neighbors, asking only that each person keep the book one week. At the end of that time, he would pick up the book and lend it to some other person. Later he came to tell me what his habit of sharing his own philosophy had done for him.

"When I started to lend those books of yours," he said, "I had no other purpose in mind than to make friends among my neighbors by introducing them to a philosophy which has so much friendship in it.

"Meanwhile I had started my machine shop with one small drill press. Very soon, some of my neighbors who had read